

— THE BLUEPRINT

THE TRADITIONAL 1V1 WINGER IS QUIETLY GOING EXTINCT.

The data on why managers are phasing them out.

A 5-part breakdown

SWIPE >>>>

0101 / 05

| THE DROP.

Final-third dribbles across Europe's top 5 leagues fell around 18% in three seasons.
Managers stopped tolerating wide turnovers.

0202 / 05

| THE CAUSE.

Rest-defence shapes (3-2, 2-3) prize safety.
Lose it out wide, you get countered through
the middle. *One mistake, one goal against.*

0303 / 05

| THE NEW WINGER.

Inside playmakers drift into the half-space for overloads. The touchline is left to inverted or overlapping full-backs. *Width without the risk.*

0404 / 05

| WHO IS DOING IT.

Guardiola, Arteta, Alonso. Flair dribblers
benched for retention and accuracy. *Control
over chaos.*

0505 / 05

| THEN VS NOW.

2016: a winger isolated in a 1v1 corridor. 2026:
a half-space playmaker plus an overlap,
making it 3v2. *Same flank, new maths.*

— THE TAKEAWAY

IS FLAIR DEAD?

Save this for matchday. Is individual flair dead, or is structure just more efficient? Tell us — follow @thearchv_ca.